Mugasha

Performed by Habib Suliman

(1950 recording)

Mugasha is surely the most well-known Haya heroic ballad, and Habib Suliman's many recorded versions of it have traveled far. Its story concerns a courtship and marriage between two supernatural beings of markedly different social standings: Mugasha, the lowly fisher-god, controller of the spirits of Lake Victoria, and Lyanyaibungo, beautiful daughter of the god-king Wamara. Mugasha is a beloved spirit, a controller of the rain and lake species that provide human sustenance, a friend of ironsmiths and potters, and a social grotesque who flouts the high-born, sophisticated ways of the royal court. Wamara, the god-king whose royal court provides one setting for the action, is often associated with death. The match between Lyanyaibungo and Mugasha is anti-romantic, based not in shared affection (as in Kachwenyanja) but in matchmaking as a discourse and an exchange between social groups. After the fisher-god's miraculous birth, which is formed in an equally remarkable 84-line poetic figure created by parallelism, the themes point to equalities and inequalities and to comparison as a public act involving status. The examples of this kind of theme are legion, beginning with Mugasha's mother's sister's decision to accept Wamara's contract, and ending with the proverbial commentary in the last lines of the ballad. The bard's elaborate comparisons serve his wit, his social commentary, and his poetic creativity. This recording of Habib's Mugasha (Mugasha I) was made in 1950 at the royal court of the then ruler of Kyamutwala kingdom, Gabriel Rugabandana, at Kabale, by Hugh Tracy, the renowned ethnomusicologist. In this otherwise remarkable and excellent performance, the singer truncates and illogically merges the two trials devised to reveal Mugasha's true mother. The missing text — taken from another recording of Habib made at the same place by Gabriel Rugabandana himself in 1980 and included in the Haya Epic Ballad Library as Mugasha II — is provided in an editorial note at that point in the performance (look for a "txt" annotation). The text of the 1980 performance is linked in the Synchrotext version to that of the 1950 performance so you can see the elaborations and other changes wrought by the poet during 30 years of his career. Look for "80e" annotations for the translated, English version and "80h" for the original Haya.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 1-3.2:

Mugasha 1 begins with seventeen lines of poetic images that are associated with the fisher-god or that foreshadow the events of the ballad.

NOTES

1 Habib Suliman addresses the *Bahyoza* , the name for residents of the Kyamutwala kingdom, where the famous bard from Kiziba often performed. Lines 1-3 are praise names associated with Mugasha and other spirits. They are quoted from the spirits' self praise poetry (*ebyebugo*), which they recite with characteristic styles when they possess spirit mediums. Bards use and conserve this knowledge. Even though there is an organization of spirit mediums, the names and praises of spirits are not standardized. *Bitankwama* : possibly "These-(insulting words)-do-not-bother-me," a name that fits Mugasha's style. *Nyabuleza* and *Kashasila* are female spirits, whose relationship to childbearing is probably invoked here. *Never-envious* (of another's child), contrasts with Mugasha's aunt (l. 78ff.). *Ties up...* and *Thorns block the pathways* are images of difficult childbirth. Ishumi 1980 reports a new mother is traditionally congratulated "there are no thorns."

Bahyoza, Hear the Epic of *Bitankwama*,
Little Feet of the Kafunzi Bird,
Nyabuleza, the Never Envious,
Kashasila, Restrains the First,
Thorns Block Pathways,
The Wrathful,
Majambwe, Bull of the Heart-Tormenters,
Speaks from the Womb,
Comes from Mutoizi,
Brooks No Argument,
Water's Surge Smashes Everything,
Surges in the Flood,
And as well
Surges in the Tree of Menstrual Pain,
Makes Bellows Breathe on Great Lake Lweru.
He refused: "I do not make my bellows breathe in town."
Go slowly, Majambwe, Bull of the Heart-Tormenters.

2.6 A *mugege* tree is used in medicine for vaginal bleeding; *engege* is menstrual pain. The tree is also used to make charcoal for ironworking.

3 *Lwelu* is the Haya name for Lake Victoria/Nyanza, probably from *okw-ela*, "to be white" referring to the reflection of sunlight and sky in the water.

Bahyoza hulila enanga ya *Bitankwama*,
Ya Bugulu bwa Kafunzi,
Nyabuleza ka Techuba,
Kashasila Nkom' ekibanda,
Malinzi gait' emihanda,
Lwa kyetabila,
Ngundu Majambwe Bashahila-mwoyo,
Kagambila-nda,
Aluga omwa Mutoizi,
Ekilema-ihanuula,
Lujagambya Lwanyakaata,
Ajagamby' omu ntunga,
Ekya kabili
Ajagamby' omu ngege,
Ajugutil' omu nyanja empango nka Lwelu.
Akanga ahi, "Tindijugutil' omukyalo."
Wehunde majambwe engundu yaBashahila-mwoyo.

3.2 *Bull of the Tormentors-of-the-heart* signifies the strongest of the Bachwezi spirits, praise for Mugasha.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 4-5.3:
Mugasha speaks from inside his mother's womb demanding birth but refusing to be born; his difficult birth torments his mother.

Lines 6-18.1:
Midwives try various remedies, but none help.

NOTES

5.3 *Frenzy* : Mugasha's mother's state is like being jerked about in a lively dance.

12.4 *Kin-of-the-Peaceful-one* is a praise name for women, people associated with Nyakalembe, "The Peaceful-one," a woman's agricultural spirit and the wife of Mugasha.

POETIC STANZAS

4-30.1: verse passage in **aabb of four verses (a 's: 4-9.1, 10-18.1; b 's: 20-25.1, 26-30.1); verse passage a 's consist of verses formed in aba by mirror stanzas; in the first verse in aba , the pattern is formed by mirror stanzas (a 's: 4-5.3, 7-9.1) composed as address to Nyambubi (4-4.4,7-7.2) + near identical lines (5-5.3, 8-9.1) contrasted with lines that are not apparently formed in a stanzaic pattern (b 's: 6-6.3); in the second verse in aba , the pattern is formed by mirror stanzas (a 's: 10-11.1, 15-18.1) composed as near identical lines (10-10.3, 15-15.3) + lines associated by incremental repetition (11-11.1, 18-18.1) contrasted with a passage (b : 12-14.1) punctuated by lines that create a pattern of aab (two linegroups, 12-12.2 and 12.3-13.1, ending markedly in *byabula nsha "they had no effect" finalized by a linegroup, 14-14.1, which also finalizes the other stanzas in this section of the figure, cf. 11-11.1, 18-18.1); verse passage b 's consist of compound stanzas in aab ; two compond stanzas in aab (20-23.2, 23.3-25.1) comprise the first b in the overall verse passage in aabb ; the first of these compound stanzas is formed in aab by linegroups composed as initial subjunctive verb + preposition + name or praisename/ praisename (a 's: 20-20.5 and 21-22); the linegroup that completes the figure (b : 23-23.2) is itself formed in aab with lines that almost repeat the former composition, locutive + subjunctive + preposition + praisename/ praisename, but are finalized by a line (23.2) marked by an initial indicative verb that shifts quoted speech to narration; the second of the compound stanzas that comprise the first b in the overall verse passage in aabb is formed by linegroups composed as initial indicative narrative verb + preposition + name or praisename/ praisename (a 's: 23.3-23.5, 24-24.4) contrasted with a linegroup that completes the figure (b : 25-25.1) by echoing phrases deployed structurally elsewhere (11-11.1, 18-18.1); the compound stanza that comprises the second b in the overall verse passage in aabb is formed in aa a b by three line groups of quoted discourse, each introduced by a locutive (a 's: 27-27.2, 28-28.4, 29) contrasted with a linegroup (b : 30-30.1) of narrated responses to the orders and acts entailed in the previous linegroups; the second linegroup in this final pattern (28-28.4) is itself a compound stanza in aab , 2 + 2 + 1, formed by couplets composed as "cut" + treename/ "carve" + wooden utensil (a 's: 28-28.1, 28.2-28.3), contrasted with a single line (b : 28.4) that shares subjunctive verb initial syntax, but ends with a prepositional phrase rather than a direct object.**

That day I saw:
He spoke to Nyambubi,
"Mother, push. Give me birth.
But fear, and I'll burst your side
Brooks No Argument."
Nyambubi pushed.
But it had no effect.
She rushed here and there.
Nyambubi was jerked into a frenzy.

Those around her said, "Get midwives."
They brought Galengaine,
Pretty packet, *Long necked calabash from Mugunda*.
The healer picked Whitener and Benefactor at the fence.

She spoke to Nyambubi:
My child, bear down. Give him birth.
The one who will end your childlessness is Mugasha."
On that day Nyambubi pushed.
But it had no effect.
She rushed here and there.
On that day, she was jerked into a frenzy.

On that day I saw.
The healer left the hearth room,
Her right hand holding as she came a hornful of tobacco.
Her left is busy too as one who makes *kilangi* extract.
The healer was confounded,
"What shall I do, my child?"

She said, "Bear down harder still."
They applied all the birthing medicines
But they had no effect.
The kind to lick and the kind to sniff,
The kind whose leaves they strip and throw in the hearth's flames,
The Kin of the Peaceful One.

On that day they did them.
But they had no effect.
The healer was confounded,
Omu kil' ekyo nkabona.
Yagambila Nyambubi,
Ati,"Mae sindikil' onzaile.
Kolatina ndakubalukila omu itundu
Ekilema-ihanula."
Nyambubi akasindikila.
Byabula nshai.
Yatel' oku n' oku.
Nyambubi yalamaijwa.

Ababaile bali 'ho bati, "Hondel' abazaza."
Baleta Galengaine,
Mutana Lushekeowa Mugunda.
Omukaikulu omu ilembo yagutul' olweza n' olugoshoola.

Yagambila Nyambubi
Ati, "Mwana wange gum' omuzale
Omwan' omo yakukumalila obugumba Mugasha."
Kil' ekyo Nyambubi akasindikila.
Byabula nshai.
Yatel' oku n' oku.
Kil' ekyo yalamaijwa.

Kil' ekyo nkabona.
Omukaikulu yaluga aha mwanya.
Mukono ogwa bulyo akaija akwete enyungu y' etaba.

Ogwa bumosho natagaita, nka akamula kilangi.
Omukaikulu yashobelwa,
Ati, "Ngilenta mwana wange?"

Ahi, "Wegumisilize."
Bataho enshamba zona
Byabula nshai.
Eyokulamba n' ogwokunukiliza,
Ogwokuhulutula mbanaga omu kyoto,

Abanyakalembe.

Kil' ekyo bagila
Byabula nshai.
Omukaikulu yashobelwa,

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 19-25.1:
Finally, a midwife suggests consulting and sacrificing to Wamara, the king of gods, and this is done.

Lines 26-30.1:
Wamara instructs the petitioners [through a spirit medium] to build Mugasha a spirit shrine.

NOTES

21 These praise names for Wamala are said to refer to serpents associated with him, who carry one another on their backs, as mothers do children.

"What shall I do my child?"

I saw her on that day:
She left the hearth room,
Her right hand holding as she came a hornful of tobacco.
Her left is busy too as one who makes *kilangi* extract.
She said, "My powers!
My powers! My powers!"
On that day the healer stood confounded,
"What shall I do? My powers!"

We said, "Elder, what has happened?"
She said, "My children, hurry! Quickly, quickly!
Pray at a spirit shrine for help, my children.

Go to Wamara,
Swaying One of Nyante,
Long of neck with rings of wrinkles,
Set Right by Tribute,
Tiny Egg of Endisa Bird,
He came from Zinzaland.
Pray to *He grows not weary when resolution is far*,
Tired in the back,
It carried those who don't drop down,
Relentless one,
Sheep of the White Region, my children."
She said, "Go to *the Swaying One of Nyante*,
Long of neck with rings of wrinkles."
We took gray goats and white sheep.

On that day we brought tribute to Wamara,
Swaying One of Nyante,
Long of neck with rings of wrinkles.
Set Right by Tribute
We brought tribute to the *Brother of the Hinda*,
Arm that Conquers,
Embracer of Warriors,
Buttocks Filled with Sweet Banana Mash,
Sewing Awl.
On that day the healer was confounded,
"What shall I do? My powers!"

I saw on that day:
The *Swaying One of Nyante* said, "My children!"
He sent Harbinger, child of Kayango,
By Misfortunes cursed.

Ati, "Ngilenta mwana wange?"

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yaluga aha mwanya.
Mukono ogwa bulyo akaija akwete enyungu y' etaba.

Ogwa bumosho natagaita nka akamula kilangi.
Ati, "Amani gange!
Amani gange! Amani gange!"
Kil' ekyo omukaikulu yaikala ashobeilwe,
Ati "Ngilenta? Amani gange!"

Tuti, "Byaba bita mukaile?"
Ati, "Bana bange iluka bwangu bwangu!
Mutakile omu byanga bana bange.

Mugy' omwa Wamala,
Luyongo lwa Nyante,
Kakyai Kagoobe,
Omugololwa-mpongano,
Ly' endisa,
Akaluga Buzinja.
Muteege *Talemwa bili halai*,
Ndemwa mugongo,
Gwahekile abatatonye,
Lwanga kubonda,
Entama ya Bwela, bana bange."
Ahi, "Mugy' omwa *Luyongo lwa Nyante*,
Kakyai kagoobe."
Twatwala ebisa n' ebitanga.

Kil' ekyo twabihonga omwa Wamala,
Luyongo lwa Nyante,
Kakyai Kagoobe.
Omugololwa-mpongano
Twabihonga omwa *Kinyanya Abahinda(kazi)*,
Mukono gwa kilema,
Afumbata emanzi,
Manyugunyu gajwile omulamba,
Mpindu ibazila.
Kil' ekyo omukaikulu yashobelwa,
Ati, "Ngilenta? Amani gange!"

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Luyongo lwa Nyante ahi, "Bana bange!"
Yasindika Lwebembela olwa Kayango,
Entegwa biyengo.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 31-37.1:
Mugasha is born; he immediately sends his uncle on a journey to get him a canoe.

NOTES

29 The *child fisherman* is Mugasha.

31 The miraculous child speaks at birth. One of Mugasha's names, *Nyatende* (31.1), is also that of his mother's sister. It refers to sheaves of crops, apropos of his association with fertility.

He said, "Go and fell a mushambya tree, the *Stretcherbearer*.
Carve from it small paddles nine.
Fell the *well-placed* mulinzi tree.
Carve from it a small canoe.
Put these in a spirit house,"
He said, "For *the child fisherman of Ishulaine Bugunda*."
The healer on that day brought them quickly, quickly.
They made the payment.

I saw:
He was born, Nyatende. He came down.
He chanted his praise. He brought it from within.
He said, "Hurry to Kishanje of Kalasha at Mutailenge's
Go to Ibebe's at Bweza.
Go tell Uncle Food-for-the-road Never-arrives
He should hurry quickly, quickly
To Nyatende Mugasha."

Stop for tape change

He said, "Uncle Food-for-the-road Never-arrives
Run quickly, quickly
I would send you to Kiziba.
Go for me to Ntumwa Magembe at Nipelasho's in Kaigoma."
He said, "Have them transport for me a canoe of eight seats.
The ninth is horn."
They went and set it down at Nyakilembeka landing.
When they had set it down at Nyakilembeka landing–
I saw on that day–
He said, "Uncle, run quickly, quickly."

Ahi, "Mugye mutem' omushambya omwinunula.

Mubaije akagai mwenda.
Muteme *omuteeko* omulinzi.
Mubaije akato.
Mubite omu kikalo."
Ati, "Omwana mujubi omwa Ishulaine Bugunda."
Omukaikulu kil' ekyo yabileta bwangu bwangu.
Babihonga.

Nkabona
Yazalwa Nyatende. Yaija aha nsi.
Yebuga. Yekologota.
Ahi, "Iluka mugye Kishanje kya Kalasha omwa Mutailenge.
Mugye omwa Ibebe Bweza.
Mugende mugambile Menshaija Katanda Katahika
Ayanguhe bwangu bwangu
Nyatende Mugasha."

Stop for tape change

Ati, "Menshaija Katanda Katahika
Iluka bwangu bwangu
Nkutume Kiziba.
Ntumwa Magembe ongobele omwa Nipelasho Kaigoma."
Ahi, "Bagende bantwekele obwato bw' entebe munana.

Eihembe lya mwenda."
Bagenda babuhumuza omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.
Olwo bakabuhumwize omu mwalo Nyakilembeka -
Nkabona kil' ekyo -
Ati, "Menshaija, iluka bwangu bwangu."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 38-47:

The infant walks out to receive people and announces his intention to travel; people are amazed (lines 38-39.4). Mugasha goes to Lake Victoria, where he summons the nature spirits he controls and announces his intentions to fish.

NOTES

37.4 *Trapper* (of fish) is a praise name for Mugasha.

40 A *cattle road* is located at least 30-40 yards from a dwelling, at the end of a forecourt. It is wider than a footpath.

41.2 *Kin-of-the-Peaceful-One* are women (12n). " *The joyful one grows joyous...* " are words of a women's song at weddings.

POETIC STANZAS

37-37.3: stanza in **abab formed by contrast between lines that contain a double verb (a 's: 37, 37.2) and lines that begin with a single verb (b 's:37.1, 37.3).**

38-38.3: stanza in **abab formed by contrast between lines that describe an action by mugasha (a 's: 38, 38.2) and those that describe a reaction by others (b 's: 38.1, 38.3).**

39-39.4: compound stanza in **aab , 2 + 2 + 1, formed by couplets (a 's: 39-39.1, 39.2-39.3) composed as 3rd sing verb initial/ direct quotation introduced by locutive contrasted with a single line that begins with a 3rd plural verb (b : 39.4).**

40-40.2: stanza in **aab formed by contrast between lines composed as subject + "that day" + verb (order reverses) (a 's: 40-40.1) and one line composed only of two verbs (b : 40.2).**

His uncle came and spoke to the child in his cradle.
He left.
The child went and he sat among the pillars of the antechamber.
He raised his hand.
I saw the Trapper on that day
When he had raised his hand,
I saw all the people were confounded.
He said, "Give to me my paddles nine, carved as I was being born."
They brought nine paddles.

He clutched one paddle.
He said, "This paddle's mine. I'll make a crossing."
He emerged into the forecourt,
They said, "He'll fall."
They saw him walking everywhere.

That day the child reached the cattle road.
His mother Nyambubi emerged that day as well.
She stood amazed.
People left the village.
They went ululating and singing,
Answering one another, the *Kin of the Peaceful One*
They sing, "The joyful one grows joyous."
They respond, "She grows joyous in her reign."

41-41.4: compound stanza in **abb , 1 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets that cohere by verb initial and locutive initial syntax, respectively (b 's: 41.1-41.2, 41.3-41.4) contrasted with a single subject initial line (a : 41).**

Nyinalumi yagya yabimugambila omwana aha bulago.
Yalugaho.
Kagya kashuntama omu nyomyo z' omu ibanga.

Kaimuky' omukono.
Nkabona kil' ekyo *Njwenge*.
Olwo yaimukiz' omukono
Nkabona abantu bona bashobelwa.
Ati, "Mp' engai zange ezobabaizile ninzalwa, engai mwenda."
Baleta engai mwenda.

Yakwata engai emoi,
Ati, "Engai yange. Ninshabula."
Yashohola omu kibuga,
Bati, "Kalagwa."
Babona kagendagenda.

Omwana kil' ekyo yagoba omu kihongolelo.
Nyambubi nyina yashohola kil' ekyo.
Yaikala ashobeilwe.
Abantu omu kyalo bahwayo.
Bagenda mbatel' empundu n' ebiina,
Nilwitika *Abanyakalembe*
Bati, "Kanyawela yela."
Bati, "Kayel' omu ngoma."

When they had walked with him to Nyakilembeka landing,
The child summoned Rushing Water of the Lake,
Whirling Child of Limb-Twister.
He said, "Whistling Wind *Blower-of-cold*,
I-never-miss-a-doorway,
Silent Runner Lightning Flash."
He summoned Thunder.
He called the winged Nshungu wind of Lwabulungu,
Great horns lie back across the shoulders,
Bad news brought by a traveler,
Puller-of-fish-lines.

He said, "This very day I'm wanting to be traveling.
This day on Great Lake Lweru,
I would go and fish *enkuyu*, *Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor*."
He said, "Empala fish, the *Long-horn enkoma mujungwizi*,
I'll catch this very day.
I'll catch *bukeije* and *bukokalongo*."

I saw the Trapper on that day.

I saw his canoe float out into the middle of the lake.
His mother Nyambubi clapped her hands.
She spread her palms.
She summoned the Sun *I-have-shone* and the Sun *He-who-creates*.
She said, "My child roams, and I await what comes like upper teeth."
I saw: The canoe came back to Nyakilembeka landing.

Kabamugobize omu mwalo Nyakilembeka,
Omwana yabilikila Mushoke gwa nyanja,
Izilinga lya nyakamyoka.
Ahi, "Kiwiwisi *Ekihutilizi-mbeho*,*Tinsiga-mulyango*,

Kachwaichwaita Kimyanso."
Abilikila Kaiyula.
Yayeta Nshungu *kapapa ka Lwabulungu*,
Bikulembe bilalile mabega,
Nkulumbi etwalwa mugenzi,
Isika-migonjo.

Ahi, "Kilo ekya mbwenu ningonza ninkyalile.
Kil' eki omu nyanja mpango nka Lwelu,
Ngende njube enkuyu, *Bilali bya kahunga*."

Ati, "Empala, *Luhembe enkoma mujungwizi*,
Nyite kilo ekya mbwenu.
Nyite obukeije n' obukokalongo."

Nkabona kil' ekyo *Njwenge*.

Nkabona obwato bwailila obuziba.
Nyambubi nyina yatela omu mikono.
Yayala ebiganja.
Yabilikila Kazoba aka Ntangaile na Kazoba aka Nyamuhanga.
Ahi, "Kai omwana nagenda, ndategela ekilija amaino ga lugulu."
Nkabona obwato bwaluga omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 48-50:
He sets out, but his mother prays to the Sun for his return, and he returns to shore.

NOTES

43.1 *Silent runner* praises lightning, which in traditional belief is silent and relatively harmless; thunder is thought to make noise and do damage.

44 *Nshungu* is a strong seasonal wind that brings cloud formations resembling the long horns of Ankole cattle.

45.2 A *forgetful debtor* avoids looking his creditor in the eye.

46 *Empala* is a type of catfish whose whiskers swing about like the long horns of an aggressive bull.

49 Mugasha's mother invokes the *Sun* in two personas: as the shining heavenly body and as the child of the Creator, Nyamuhanga.

49.1 The emergence of *the upper teeth* of an infant before the lower is understood as an extremely unfortunate sign. It becomes an image for any grave misfortune that may befall a child and its mother.

POETIC STANZAS

42.1-44.3: stanza in **ab bb a a b bb formed by contrast between lines: composed as [child] + calls + spiritname (a 's: 42.1, 43.2, 44); and lines composed as praisename alone (b 's: 42.2, 43, 43.1, 44.1, 44.2, 44.3).**

45-46.2: compound stanza in **aab , 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets composed as double verb/ Ø verb (a 's: 45-45.1, 45.2-46) and a couplet that coheres by repetition of "I'll catch" in initial position (b : 46.1-46.2).**

48-50: verse in **aba , 1 + 4 + 1, formed by single lines that begin "I saw" + "canoe": (a 's: 48, 50) contrasted with four lines (b : 48.1-49.1) that form a stanza in aa a b by contrast between lines with 3rd person near past verbs in (near) initial position (a 's: 48.1-49) and a single line of quoted speech beginning with a locutive.**

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 51-54.1:
Mugasha lives on the lake for eight years and in the ninth decides to visit his mother.

Lines 55-59.2:
On the shore he sees nine women, but cannot tell which is his mother; he feigns drowning so his mother will reveal herself by saving him.

Lines omitted by mistake:
[Missing in this version (because the singer has collapsed similar episodes) is the following action: Mugasha's mother's sister runs into the lake to save him but fearfully backs out when the water reaches her chest, leaving Mugasha still ignorant of his mother's identity. Then the god Wamara, who happens to be there, devises another test. To whoever will take his grandson Kagoro's copper spear and kill Mugasha, Wamara will grant nine children.]

Lines 60-6.3:
Mugasha's mother's sister reasons that nine children outweigh one, takes the spear, but is prevented from throwing it by Nyambubi, Mugasha's mother. Nyambubi wins the trial.

NOTES

57 I have substituted “Trapper” for “elder woman” (*omukaikulu* in the actual transcription) referring to the midwife, to correct what appears to be a mistake.

59 Mugasha's being *swallowed by the water* is a laughable ruse, for he is the spirit that controls its power.

POETIC STANZAS

52.1-54.1: compound stanza in **abab , 1 + 2 + 1 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that essentially repeat (b 's: 52.2-52.3, 54-54.1) and single lines (a 's: 52.1, 53).**

56-57.1: compound stanza in **abb , 1 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by parallelism and repetition (b 's: 56.1-56.2, 57-57.1) and a single line that begins with a locutive (a : 56).**

Out in the middle of the lake Mugasha spent eight years.
In the ninth he summoned Rushing Water.
He said, "*Lake-dweller*, *Puller-of-fish-lines*, I'm wanting:

I would go to where I first set out,
I would travel and see my mother, who gave birth to me,
I would see her, who pushed for me."
When they had paddled on that day, the Trapper,
He said, "I would go and see my mother, who gave birth to me.
I would see her, who pushed for me."

From out in the middle he saw nine women.
They were drawing water at Nyakilembeka landing.
He said, "Among those women
I cannot tell the one who gave birth to me.
I cannot tell the one who pushed for me, Mugasha."
He was confounded on that day, the Trapper.
He sat there confounded.
When he saw the nine women,

He made a man's plan.
He jumped from the canoe.
He threw himself into the lake, Mugasha.
He threw out his arm.
He called, "Come grab hold, save me! The water is swallowing me!"
That day they were confounded.

I saw: The women all fell into a quandary.
Mugasha's aunt said, "Let me impale Mugasha. I'll kill him.
They'll give me nine children.
These cannot be outweighed by Nyambubi's one child."

58.1-59.1: stanza in **aa aaa b , formed by contrast between lines that begin with 3rd person near-past (a 's: 58.1-59) and a single line of quoted speech that begins with a locutive.**

Mugasha obuziba akamalayo ebyanda munana.
Ekya mwenda yabilika Mushoke.
Ahi, "Gwa nyanja, *Isika-migonjo* ningonza

Ngobe mbali nsaabile,
Ngende mbone mawe ayanzaile,

Mbone ayansindikiile."
Olwo bakabukile kil' ekyo, *Njwenge*,
Ahi, "Ngye mbone mawe ayanzaile.

Mbone ayansindikiile."

Akema obuziba yabona abakazi mwenda.
Mbataha amaizi omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.
Ati, "Aha abakazi abo,
Tinkumanya ayanzaile.
Tinakumanya ayansindikiile, Mugasha."
Yashobelwa kil' ekyo omukaikulu.
Yaikala ashobeilwe.
Olwo yaboine abakazi mwenda,

Yakola magezi ga bashaija.
Yaluga omu bwato.
Yenaga omu nyanja Mugasha.
Yanag' omukono.
Ati, "Mwije munkwate. Amaizi gandya!"

Kil' ekyo bashobelwa.

Nkabona abakazi bona bagwa omu bitangalo.
Nyinento Mugasha ahi, "Kanchumite Mugasha, mwite.

Balampa abana mwenda.
Tibalikwigana mwan' omoi wa Nyambubi."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 67-86.2:
Mugasha returns to the lake and one day sees Wamara's daughter gathering straw. He proposes to her but she rejects him. He swears he will marry her; she swears he will not.

NOTES

64 For *Big eyes…forgetful debtor* see 45.1n.

68 *Nyatende* refers to Mugasha.

70.2 *Bull* denotes leadership and preeminence and is used in praise of the maiden — she is the most pleasing among maidens, like deep red wild figs, *the kalaito* fruit. Her stature is parallel and opposed to that of Mugasha, who is called the Bull of the Tormenters-of-the-Heart — first among the Bachwezi spirits of possession (ll. 1.6, 94.1).

71 ff. Lyanyaibungo was gathering straw to place on the floor of a dwelling. Work of this kind comes under the category of "to make things pleasing" a knowledge especially associated with marriagable young women.

POETIC STANZAS

63.1-65.1: stanza in **a aa bab formed by contrast between lines (or a linegroup) that begins with a locutive and contains an ethical judgement (a 's: 63.1-63.3, 65) and lines composed as "they gave her" + fish name (b 's: 64, 65.1).**

67.1-69.1: compound stanza in **aba**, 4 + 4 + 1, by repetition and syntactic parallelism; **a**'s (67.1-.4, 69.1) are structured as 3rd person near past verb initial; **b** (67.5, 68, 69) forms another figure in **aba**: **a**'s are structured as "I saw he passed" + placename; **b** (68) begins with a prepositional phrase and ends with the subject.

70-71.2: compound stanza in **aba , 3 + 4 + 3, formed by contrast between number sequences (a 's: 70-70.2, 71-71.2) and lines that refer to Wamala (b 's: 70.3-70.6).**

When she raised up the spear, Nyambubi grabbed her from below.
She said, "This thing won't kill my child for me!
It wasn't I who brought its childlessness."
That day he was astonished, *Majambwe the Trapper*.
I saw those present.
They said, "Nyambubi, you win the case.
There is no woman who'd kill the child she bore.
Nyambubi, the child is yours."
They gave her an *enkuyu* fish, *Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor*.
65 They said, "Mother's sisters should not leave empty handed."
I saw them give her *bukeije* and *bukena* minnows.

On that day, *Nyatende*,
Trapper,
Water-dweller,
Mugasha.

Stop for tape change

When he had found the mother who had borne him, the Trapper,
He returned to Great Lake Lweru.
He took hold of his canoe.
He passed by Kishanje village of Kalasha at Mutailenge's house.
He alighted at the home of Ibebe at Bweza.
I saw: he passed Rubafu at the waters of Nyamataba.
At Kanyabagwa beach, Nyatende, the Trapper.
I saw: he passed Kyahu island of Nyakwezi.
He cast his eyes towards Bitterness Marsh, Mugasha.

70 That was when he saw eight maidens.
The ninth was Lwanyaibungo,
Bull of the Pretty Kalaito.
The maiden was the daughter of Wamara,
Swaying One of Nyante,
Long of Neck with Rings of Wrinkles,
Set Right by Tribute.
She'd gathered straw: four and four, eight bundles;
The ninth she clutched in her hand;
The tenth she pressed underfoot.

Kayalyetwekile Nyambubi yaluga aha nsi yamukwata.

Ahi, "Kitanyitila mwana!
Tinye nakileteile bugumba."
Kil' ekyo yashobelwa *Majambwe Njwenge*.
Nkabona ababaile bali 'ho
Bati, "Nyambubi nosinga omushango.
Taliho mukazi alaisile mwana amuzaile.
Nyambubi, omwana wawe."
Bamuha enkuyu, *Bilali bya kahunga*.

65 Bahi, "Banyinento muntu tibalugaho busha."

Nkabona bamuha obukeije n' obukena.

Kil' ekyo *Nyatende*,
Njwenge,
Ky' omu maizi,
Mugasha.

Stop for tape change

Olwo yakasigile yabona nyina alikumuzala, *Njwenge*,

Yashuba omu nyanja mpango nka Lwelu.
Yakwata obwato.
Yezinga Kishanje kya Kalasha omwa Mutailenge.

Yatonya omwa Ibebe Bweza.
Nkabona yezinga Rubafu omuga Nyamataba.
Aha munwa gwa Kanyabagwa, *Nyatende Njwenge*.
Nkabona yezinga Kyahu kya Nyakwezi.
Yanaga amaisho omu izinga Bushungu, Mugasha.

70 Nilwo yaboine abaisiki munana.
Owa mwenda akaba ali Lwanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito.
Omwisiki ogwo abali muhala wa Wamala,
Luyongo lwa Nyante,
Kakyai Kagobe,
Omugolowa mpongano.
Akaba yaiya obunyasi emiganda ena munana;
Ogwa mwenda agukwete omu byala;
Ogwa ikumi akashangwa agulibatile.

NOTES

82 ff. Kagolo's praise alludes to his hot-headed and warlike behavior, which spirit mediums embody when they are possessed by him.

82.3 *Dry words* are strong and effective, as opposed to 'wet' words, which are weak.

82.4 *Stiff Elbows* probably reflects his demeanor as a possessing spirit; it seems to reinforce in gestural language his extreme and immoderate behavior.

81.5 Mother's child is a way of referring to one's sibling (here, a brother) that connotes affection.

83.2 The water oracle (*Byantabuzi*) is associated with this spirit (its name comes from *oku-tabula*, "to make water bubble up or forth"). Byantabuzi also echoes the name of the place where Kagolo acquired his characteristic way of talking (l. 143.3).

POETIC STANZAS

72-74.2: compound stanza in **aab , 3 + 3 + 3, by virtue of contrast between lines of narration of the wind's attack (a 's: 72-72.2, 73-73.2) and those that describe the daughter's defeat and speech (b 's: 74-74.2)**

73-84: repeated line (75, 76.1, 78.4 and 84) finalizes passages of the winds' appearance, the girls' desertion, Mugasha's proposal and Lyanyaibungo's reply

79-80.2: stanza in annular structure - **abcba - by contrast between lines composed as aside (in distant past tense)/ locutive + 2nd person/ Ø verb descriptor/ locutive + 2nd person/ aside.**

81-86.2: verse in **aba formed by mirror stanzas (a 's: 81-81.5, 85-86.2) composed as formulaic aside (81, 86)/ communicative act described (81.1-2, 85.1-.2)/ address (81.3, 86)/ statement involving marriage, inflected as contrary-to-fact (81.4, 86.1)/ vowed incest (81.5, 86.2) contrasted with lines composed as praise/ formulaic line (b 's: 82-84).**

The child was surprised by Whistling Wind,
Blower-of-cold, I-never-miss-a-doorway.
That straw, the Wind strewed and strewed about.
She pressed and pressed it together with her skirt.
But it had no effect.
She sat down on the ground.
She swore, "O father!
Swaying One of Nyante."
The maiden on that day was confounded.

Her companions ran, they left her.
She sat there confounded.

She'd not gotten the words out of her mouth
When suddenly Nyatende appeared,
Bull of the Heart-Tormenters.
Speaker from the Womb,
Comes from Mutoizi,
Brooks No Argument.
He said, *"I am the only child.*
I ended my mother's childlessness."
"Maiden, I would court you, I would marry you."
The maiden on that day sat there confounded.

I saw:
She said, "You are not one to marry me,
Little fisherman of Ishulaine Bugunda."
She said, "Die without issue! You stink!"
That day Mugasha had tied on his cloak of dried minnows.
I saw on that day.
The maiden spat.
Spittle scattered.
She said, "I swear to you Mugasha:
Rather than have you marry me
I'd sleep with my mother's child, Kagolo."
She said, *"Of the Spirit Shrine,*
Of the Water Oracle,
Missile of Despair,
Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,
With Stiffened Elbows."
She said, *"Adorned with beads all over except the palm,*
Of the Left-handers,
Of the Water Oracle."
The maiden on that day sat confounded.

I saw on that day:
He spoke, Nyatende,

Omwana akechula Kiwiwisi,
Ekihutilizi-mbeho, Tinsiga mulyango
Obunyasi omuyaga gwabunaganaga.
Yabumbabumba n' akashenshe
Byabula nshai.
Yashuntama aha nsi.
Yanahila ati, "Iwe tata!
Luyongo lwa Nyante."
Omwisiki kil' ekyo yashobelwa.

Batahibe bailuka bamusiga.
Yaikala ashobeilwe.

Akaba atakakihil' omu kanwa
Lyamuleeta *Nyatende*,
Ngundu ya Bashahila-mwoyo.
Kagambila-nda,
Naluga omwa Mutoizi,
Ekilema-ihanuula.
Ahi, "*Inye ndi mwana omoi.*
Nkamalila mawe obugumba.
Mwisiki nkushelele nkushwele."
Omwisiki kil' ekyo akaikala ashobeilwe.

Nkabona.
Ahi, "Toina kunshwela,
Akajubu k' omwa Ishulaine Bugunda."
Ahi, "Chwekamu! Nonuka!"
Kil' ekyo Mugasha akaba ashumukile ebeebo y' obukanda.
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Omwisiki yachw' enyili.
Zatalaka.
Ahi, "Nkwenahilile Mugasha
Nangu kawakunshwela,
Ninkanyiame n' omwana wa mawe, Kagolo."
Ati, "*Akomu lwanga*,
Ka Byantabuzi,
Luhuba lwa kachubya,
Butoto bwa Kyomya,
Nkokola zabaile igandami."
Ahi, "*Buhunzile bwona busigaize akaganja*,
Bwa nyin' emosho,
Ka Byantabuzi."
Omwisiki kil' ekyo yaikala ashobeilwe.

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Nagamba *Nyatende*,

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 87-102.1:
Mugasha summons his minions, and they attend, identify themselves with praise epithets, and promise to assist Mugasha in his marriage plan.

NOTES

87.3 *They-die-but-they've-been-told* is the name of Mugasha's drum.

88.1 *Roaring* here translates *ngu* , a conjunction sometimes used to introduce indirect discourse. Here it seems onomatopoetic.

POETIC STANZAS

86.3-87.3: compound stanza in **abb , 1 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets (a 's: 87-87.1, 87.2-87.3) each introduced by a locutive, and cohering respectively by enjambment (name/ praisename) parallelism (initial 2nd person subjunctive).**

88-91.1: compound stanza in **abab ab formed between lines composed as praisename final (a 's: 88, 90, 91) and those that represent drum sound (b 's: 88.1-.2, 89-89.1, 90.1-.2, 91.1).**

Little Feet of the Kafunzi Bird.
He said, "Maiden, this very day
If I should fail to marry you
I'd lie with my own mother, Nyambubi."

He summoned Rushing Water.
He said, "Rushing Water of the Lake,
Whirling Child of Limb-Twister,"
He said, "Go inside the Mugoma rocky outcrop.
Sound my great drum–They-die But-they've-been-told."

He went and sounded They-die But-they've-been-told,
Roaring Di-di-di,
Roaring De-de-de.
Roaring Di-di-di,
Roaring De-de-de.
I saw that day They-die But-they've-been-told,
Roaring Di-di-di,
Roaring De-de-de.
I saw it speak, They-die But-they've-been-told,
Roaring Di-di-di.

Bugulu bwa Kafunzi.
Ahi, "Mwisiki, kilo ekya mbenu,
Kanakuba ntakushweile,
Ninkalale na mawe, Nyambubi."

Yabilika Mushoke.
Ati, "Mushoke gwa nyanja,
Izilinga lya nyakamyoka,"
Ati, "Ogende omu kyazi ekya Mugoma.
Ogy' otagalule engoma yange mpango - *Bafa Bagambilwe*."

Yagya yagitagalula *Bafa Bagambilwe*,
Ngu Di-di-di
Ngu De-de-de.
Ngu Di-di-di,
Ngu De-de-de.
Nkabona kil' ekyo *Bafa Bagambilwe*,
Ngu Di-di-di,
Ngu De-de-de.
Nkabona yalaha *Bafa Bagambilwe*,
Ngu Di-di-di.

NOTES

95 *Ensenene grasshoppers* are caught, dressed, cooked, and eaten as a great delicacy that comes once a year, during the short rainy season. They are usually caught singly with the hand. The tasty grasshopper boasts that there will be so many as to be scooped up in large baskets.

98.1 “Where could we go…?” is a question that speaks to the virtue and shame invested in the events. The lowly fisherman acts on behalf of many.

POETIC STANZAS

91.2-102.1: verse passage formed by repeated sequences of three types of lines: [verb of entry or appearance] + animal name (91.2, 92, 92.3, 93, 94, 95, 97, 99.1, 99.3, 100.1, 101.2)/ praisenames of animal (91.3, 92.4, 93.1-.2, 95.1-96.1, 99.2, 102-102.1)/ locutive + "you marry her, Mugasha"

There attended on that day *nkuyu* fish,
Big eyes skyward like a forgetful debtor.
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
There attended catfish.
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
I saw on that day.
I saw the *empala* fish,
Long-horn enkoma mujungwizi.
It said, "You marry her, Trapper!"
Hippopotamus
Smasher of Long Canoes
Old Man of the Waves,
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
I saw frogs and *bukena* minnows
Saying, "You marry her, Trapper!"

Up and spoke the *nsenene* grasshopper.
It said, *"I am Lwakyenge and Lagaza*
My head is a thin straw; my foot is njulujunga.
I'll fall four and four, eight days in Kyamutwala.
The ninth will be a time for bushel baskets.
You marry her, Trapper!"

Thunder, *Essential Warrior*,
He said, "You marry her Mugasha!"
He said, "If you didn't marry Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Where could we go, Trapper?"
I saw on that day.
He was confounded, Mugasha.

I saw on that day.
He looked at the *empala* fish,
Long-horn enkoma mujungwizi,
And at *bukena* minnows.
I saw on that day:
The *enkolongo* fish as well,
It said, "You marry her, Mugasha!"
I saw on that day.
Up spoke the locust,
He said, "*I am the sharpening stone,*
Lover of the Mountain Pass . . ."

Stop for tape change

Lyahulula kil' ekyo Nkuyu,
Bulali bya kahunga.
Ati, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Yahulula Enshonzi.
Eti, "Nomushela Mugasha!"
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Nkabona empala.
Luhembe enkoma mujungwizi.
Eti, "Nomushwela *Njwenge*!"
Enjubu,
Kyata mato,
Mukulu w' amayengo,
Eti, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Nkabona Ebikele n' Obukena.
Biti, "Nomushwela *Njwenge*!"

Yaimuka yagamba Nsenene,
Ati, "Ndi *Lwakyenge na Lagaza*
Akatwe misheke; akagulu njulujunga.
"*Ndagwa ebilo binai na bina munana Kyamutwala*
Ekya mwenda kulaba kuhunga.
Nomushwela *Njwenge*!"

Nkuba *Kanyalumanzi*
Ati, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Ati, "Otashwele Lyanyaibungo, Mugasha,
Twakugy' ahai *Njwenge?*"
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yashobelwa Mugasha.

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yaleba Empala,
Luhembe enkoma mujungwizi,
N' obukena.
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
N' Enkolongo,
Eti, "Nomushwela Mugasha!"
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Yaimuka yagamba Nzige,
Ahi, "*Inye ndi lwa kamahyolo*,
Lugonza empalo…"

Stop for tape change

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 103-106.3:
Mugasha asks them about the items of brideprice and other gifts needed for a wedding, and he makes substitutions for them with lake animals.

Lines 107-113.3:
At Wamara's palace, a party of lake dwellers arrives to arrange a marriage. Wamara rejects the suit, and with his power alters the appearance of several of the animals who attend.

NOTES

106.5 The *frog's song* and the events it alludes to apparently come from a folktale, but I have not been able to find the one.

POETIC STANZAS

103.3-106.1: two verse passages formed by Mugasha's general questions about brideprice and wedding gifts, respectively (103.3 and 104) and answers and Mugasha's substitutions composed in pairs as locutive + answer/ locutive + substitution (103.4-103.5, 103.6-103.7 and 104.1-104.2, 104.3-104.4, 105.1-105.2, 105.4-105.5, 106-106.1); note interpolated formulaic lines (105 and 105.3) and finalizing repetition of "confounded" (106.3).

On that day I saw.
He asked them . . .
I saw on that day . . .

He said, "You who've come, tell me–to marry at the *Swaying One of Nyante's*, what kind of brideprice do they give?"
That day they told him.
"They give cattle, my lord."
He said, "Take hippopotami."
They said, "But my friend, what about sheep?"
He said, "Take crocodiles."
On that day, Mugasha.

I saw him say, "But my friends, what else do they do?"
That day they said, "Butterfat for the bride."
He said, "Take *bukena* minnow scales. Fill a snail shell with them."
They said, "Bring a bedsheet for the mother's sister."
He said, "Strings of dried *bukanda* fish."
I saw that day.
They said, "Iron pruning tools?"
He said, "Bring tilapia."
I saw that day, Mugasha.
They said, "Cattle?"
He said, "Bring hippopotami."
They said, "A sheep?"
He said, "Take a crocodile."

That day he sat confounded, Nyatende
Bull of the Heart-Tormenters.

That day, the *Swaying One of Nyante* was surprised by frogs, jumping and jumping.
They sang, "They'll tell of this."
They said, "They'll tell of this.
They'll tell of this.
They'll tell of this."
They said, "What did I say to you, Father Grunter?
I said, 'Free me from a trap and I'll free you.'
What did I tell you my blood brother?
I said, 'Free me from a trap and I'll free you.'"

Kil' ekyo nkabona.
Yababaza ati...
Nkabona kil' ekyo

Ati, "Inywe abaija kushwela omwa *Luyongo lwa Nyante*, bajugaki?"

Kil' ekyo bamugambila bati,
"Waitu, bajuga ente."
Ahi, "Mutwale Enjubu."
Bati, "Bojo si, embuzi y' Entama?
Ahi, "Mukwate Enshambi."
Kil' ekyo Mugasha.

Nkabona ati, "Bojo si, mbagile' ntai?"
Kil' ekyo bati, "Amajuta g' omugole."
Ahi, "Mukwate amakamba g' obukena. Mwijuze akashogoto."
Bati, "Twal' eishuka lya nyinento."
Ati, "Ekitundu ky' obukanda."
Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Bati, "Ebihosho?"
Ahi, "Mutwale ebigege."
Nkabona kil' ekyo, Mugasha.
Bati, "Ente?"
Ati, "Mutwale enjubu."
Bati, "Embuzi y' entama?"
Ahi, "Mukwate enshambi."

Kil' ekyo yaikala ashobeilwe, *Nyatende Engundu ya bashahila mwoyo*.

Kil' ekyo *Luyongo lwa Nyante* akechula ebikele, mbichokachoka.
Bikwete, "Balikagana."
Biti, "Balikagana
Balikagana
Balikagana."
Biti, "Nkakugambilaki Ishe Lukimbila?
Nti, 'Ntegulula ndikutegulula.'
Nkakugambilaki munywani wange?
Nti, 'Ntegulula ndikutegulula.'"

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 114-114.8:
Mugasha then sends a hailstorm, and Wamara agrees, handing over his daughter to the wedding party.

Lines 115-121:
The party meets Mugasha at the shore and hands Wamara's daughter over; Mugasha worries about Kagoro.

NOTES

110.1 On the day before a bride leaves home to live with her husband's family, an elder representative of the husband's clan comes bearing a spear to make a speech. The fish who performs this act here is a kind of catfish, whose spear Wamara fused to his back.

111 The *maiden of the hafted knife* is a young girl who accompanies the speech-making, spear-bearing elder. Her cultural butterfat becomes natural slime by the power of Wamala.

113.3 *Drink it at the spearshaft of Ndekezi* is a proverbial expression for committing suicide. The phrase refers to a poison ordeal administered by a medium of the spirit Kimuli.

114.8 The bull of Nyambubi refers to Mugasha.

POETIC STANZAS

110-112.2: verse passage in **aba , 3 + 3 + 3, formed by three triplets each composed as animal substitution/ attribute of wedding role/ permanent attribute of animal; first and third triplets are essentially the same.**

113-114.8: verse passage in **aba , 4 + 4 + 5, formed by linegroups (a 's: 113-113.3, 114.4-114.8) composed as I saw + that day + [name]/ praisename/ locutive + 2 or 3 lines that first enunciate refusal (113.2-.3) then acceptance (114.6-.8), contrasted with an intervening linegroup (b : 114-114.3) that is internally formed as aba by contrast between lines composed as "he sent" + direct object (a 's: 114, 114.3) and lines that are formulaic repetitions (b 's:114.1, 114.2).**

110 That day when I looked into the reception room,
I found the *enkolongo* making a wedding speech.
The spear that *enkolongo* held on his shoulder,
Is the spike that's now stuck on his back.
The maiden of the hafted knife was a catfish.
She'd spread on so much butterfat for sleekness
That today to grasp a catfish, you first must pat some mud.
The elder who made the courting speech was *enkonlongo*.
The spear he held on his shoulder,
Is the spike that's now stuck on his back.

I saw on that day:
The Swaying One of Nyante
He said, "Before I'd give a daughter to Mugasha,
I'd drink from the spear of Ndekezi."
He sent all these things.
But they had no effect.
I saw Mugasha on that day:
He sent Hailstones, child of Earthquake.
On that day I saw Wamara,
Swaying One of Nyante:
He said, "Give her to him.
Let her go and marry him,
The bull of Nyambubi."
115 When they handed her over to them,
They set her down on Nyakilembeka landing.
There they met Nyatende Mugasha.
Spoken:

110 Kil' ekyo kanagile kuleba omu ibanga,
Nkashanga enkolongo netela omushango.
Nkolongo eichumu 'lyoyabaile ataile aha ibega,
Nilyo ihwa lyagikwete aha mugongo.
Omwisiki w' omuholo akaba ali nshonzi.
Amajuta 'gayabaile ayesigile okutelela,
Na mambwenu koija kukwat' enshonzi, okalakal' akashabo.
Omugulusi w' okutela omushango akaba ali Nkolongo.
Eichumu 'lyoyabaile ataile aha ibega
Nilyo ihwa 'lyagikwete aha mugongo.

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Luyongo lwa Nyante
Ahi, "Kanakusigila Mugasha,
Nakuganywa aha lubango lwa Ndekezi."
Yasindikila ebintu byona
Byabula nshai.
Nkabona Mugasha kil' ekyo.
Yasindika Lubale olwa Misisi.
Kil' ekyo nkabona Wamala,
Luyongo lwa Nyante
Ahi, "Mumuhe.
Agye amushwele,
Engundu ya Nyambubi."
115 Olwo bakamuheleza,
Bamuhumuza omu mwalo Nyakilembeka.
Bamushangaho Nyatende Mugasha.
Spoken

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 122-125.3:
Mugasha returns to the lake with Wamara's daughter, while at Wamara's palace, Kagoro returns, inquires what happened, equips himself with bow and arrows, and goes to find the daughter.

NOTES

122.3 For exegesis of Kagolo's praise, see 82n.

117-138.3 These lines are spoken in a rapid recitative. *Welata* is supposed to be a word in the Ganda language. Mugasha speaks Haya with a Ganda accent and uses some Ganda vocabulary, because comes from the north, from the Sesse Islands of Uganda in Lake Victoria/Nyanza.

121 These vocables are sung in the melody of a fisherman's paddling song.

124-142.1 *I have nothing, nothing to compare it to* , a confession of defeat: Wamala's rhetorical inability to make comparisons is equated with his lack of physical mastery.

POETIC STANZAS

122-122.7: stanza in **aabb bbbb formed by a couplet and a longer linegroup that cohere, respectively, by parallelism (3 verb figure) and enjambment (name / praisenames...).**

122.8-124.2: compound stanza in **aa a b , 2 + 2 + 2 + 1, formed by utterances in couplets (a 's: 122.8-122.9, 122.10-123, 124-124.1) that cohere by enjambment, authorial reference (aside), and by chaining, contrasted with a single line utterance (b : 124.2) that abruptly changes topic and finalizes the exchange.**

124.3-124.8: compound stanza in **aab , 2 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets that cohere by parallelism and repetition (a 's: 124.3-124.4, 124.5-124.6) contrasted with a couplet that coheres as a number sequence.**

125-125.3: stanza in **abab formed by contrast between lines that constitute dependent clauses (a 's: 125, 125.2) and lines, each an independent clause, that are composed as [plant name] + "changed" + plant name (b 's: 125.1, 125.3).**

He said, "And you, welata,
Rushing Water of the Lake, *(Puller)-of-fish-lines*,"
He said, "*Whirling Kamengo of Limb-Twister Kabantende*,
I welcome you from your journey, welata."
They said, "Indeed."

He said, "And when you got there, did you meet Kagolo,

Of the Spirit Shrine,
Of the Water Oracle, Welata?"
They said, "We did not meet him there, my lord."
He said, "Paddle swiftly!
Don't you know Kagolo's coming to churn the lake up,
With the children still in the middle, Welata?"
Return to singing
Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya

He went and he married her.
He stayed inside with her four and four, eight days.
Then suddenly appeared (at Wamara's palace)–Kagolo,
Of the Spirit Shrine,
Of the Water Oracle,
Missile of Despair,
Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,
With Stiffened Elbows.

On that day when he had come,
He said, "Where is she, our child Lyanyaibungo?"
Her father said, "The Trapper took her."
I saw his father confounded on that day.

He said, "My child, I have nothing,
Nothing to compare it to."
Kagolo said, "Give me my bow."

They gave him one of the *mushambya* tree, *Stretcher Bearer*.
They gave him one of the coffee tree.
He took it. He strung it.
He took a bow of the *mukanshe* tree.
He went with eight arrows in his quiver.
The ninth went in his hand, saying clacking words.

In the places where he passed were plantain banana plants.
They became Raffia palms.
When he reached the main road,

Ati, "Na iwe welata,
Emisoke nyanja *ly' emigongo*,"
Eti, "*Ezilinga Kamengo lya Nyakamyoka Kabantende*,
Mwaihyukayo welata"
Bati, "Eho."

Ati, "Nawe bwe mwatuka mwamala mwamusangamu Ekagolo,
Ak' omu lwanga,
Ka Byantabuzi, Welata?"
Bahi, "Titwamushangamu waitu."
Ahi, "Buga bwangu.
Timumanyile Kagolo naija kufulungula enyanja,
Abana bali aha buziba, Welata."
Return to singing
Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya Ya-ya

Yagenda yamushwela.
Yamumazamu ebilo binai na bina munana.
Lyamuleeta Kagolo,
K' omu lwanga,
Ka Byantabuzi,
Luhuba lwa kachubibya,
Butoto bwa kyomya,
Ow' enkokola zabaile igandami.

Kil' ekyo olwo yakaizile,
Ati, "Alinkaha omwana waitu Lyanaibungo?"
Ishe ati, "Akamutwala *Njwenge*."
Nkabona ishe yashobelwa kil' ekyo.

Ati, "Mwana wange tinyina,
Tinyina kya kulenga."
Kagolo ahi, "Mpa Obutai bwange."

Bamuha obw' omushambya *omwinunula*.

Bamuha obw' omumwani.
Yakwata. Yalega.
Yakwat' obw' omukanshe.
Yagenda n' emihambi munana.
Ogwa mwenda gwamugenda omu byala, ngugamba ejenjenje.

Mbali yatwetwe zili ngemu.

Zahinduk' emihunge.
Kayagobile omu kihongolelo,

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 126-132.2:
At the lake Kagoro calls to Mugasha, who tries to hide himself. Kagoro strikes Mugasha in the leg with an arrow.

Lines 133-134.8:
Mugasha cuts off his leg and decides to return Wamara's daughter.

NOTES

127 *Looked over with one eye* . To look at a person briefly, with the head turned making one eye prominent communicates a hostile, or at least not a friendly, disposition.

POETIC STANZAS

129-132.2: compound stanza in **abab , 2 + 2 + 2 + 5, formed by contrast between couplets composed as "that day" + I saw [Kagolo]/ "he was confounded" (a 's: 129-130, 131-131.1) and lines composed of praisenames (b 's: 130.1-130.2, 131.2-132.2).2**

Mushunshu plants became *bjieela*.

On that day I saw:
Kagolo came to the great lake Lweru.
He called, "Mugasha, come carry me.
I would go and see our child Lyanyaibungo
Bull of the Pretty Kalaito."

Mugasha looked over with one eye.
He said, "There is Kagolo *of the Spirit Shrine*."
He got a cloud of lake flies and hid inside.

Kagolo let fly eight arrows.
They fell into the lake.
The ninth caught Mugasha in the leg.
He was startled: "I've been pricked by the spike of an *enkolongo*."

I saw Kagolo on that day.
Confounded was he,
Of the Spirit Shrine,
Of the Water Oracle.
I saw on that day:
He was confounded, Kagolo,
Of the Spirit Shrine,
Of the Water Oracle.
Missile of Despair,
Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,
With Stiffened Elbows.

Stop for tape change

I saw on that day:
His own leg–the Trapper lopped it off.
He threw it in the lake.
He went inside the Mugoma rocky outcrop.
He took out Lyanyaibungo,
Bull of the Pretty Kalaito.

He said, "Come I'll take you.
Your people have followed you.
I cannot marry you.
I've been disfigured in my leg, Nyatende
(*Bull of*) *The Heart-Tormenters*."

I saw on that day:
Mugasha paddled.
That day swiftly, swiftly.

Emishunshu yahinduk' ebijeela.

Kil' ekyo nkabona
Kagolo yagoba anyanja empango nka Lwelu.
Ati, "Mugasha, ij' ontwale.
Ngye ndebe omwana waitu Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito."

Mugasha akalebayo limoi.
Ati, "Olinya ni Kagolo *K' omu lwanga*."
Yaleta eishami yesikiliza.

Kagolo akataishula emihambi munana.
Negwa omu nyanja.
Ogwa mwenda gwamukwata okugulu.
Yechula ahi, "Nakozibwa eihwa ly' enkologo."

Nkabona kil' ekyo Kagolo.
Yashobelwa,
K' omu lwanga,
Ka Byantabuzi.
Nkabona kil' ekyo
Yashobelwa Kagolo,
K' omu lwanga,
Ka Byantabuzi.
Luhuba lwa kachubya,
Butoto bwa kyomya,
Ow' enkokola zabaile igandami.

Stop for tape change

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Okugulu *Njwenge* yegutula.
Yanaga omu nyanja.
Yataha omu kyazi ekya Mugoma.
Yamwihyamu Lyanyaibungo,
Engundu y' akakalaito.

Ahi, "Ija nkutwale.
Ab' owanu bakuhondile.
Tinakushwela.
Ndemaile kugulu, *Nyatende*,
Bashahila mwoyo."

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Mugasha akabuga.
Kil' ekyo bwangu bwangu.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 135-147.3:
Mugasha orders Thunderstorm to split a boulder and trap Kagoro with only his head above. He beats Kagoro until he loses the power of rational speech. Mugasha concludes with a proverb on the importance of equal exchange.

NOTES

143-143.3 Kagolo's power to alter natural species recalls that of Wamala.

POETIC STANZAS

137.1-137.3: stanza in **aab formed by contrast between lines that constitute dependent clauses and begin with an adverbial past perfect (a 's: 137.1, 137.2) and a single line of quoted speech.**

138-141.2: compound stanza in **aab , 2 + 2 + 9, formed by contrast between couplets referring to Mugasha composed as locutive + "I have come" + subject (name or praisename)/ praisename (a 's: 138-138.1, 139-139.2) and lines referring to Kagolo that begin identically, but append many more praisenames (b 's: 139.3-141.2).**

When he had paddled about two miles:
He saw that day–
There he stopped, confounded.
He felt great pain.

I saw on that day:
His leg, the Trapper–

He summoned Thunder, *Essential Warrior*, that day.
He said, "Be quick!
I would meet Kagolo at the landing.
He'll have nothing to compare it to."
[*False start:* When he let loose a single bolt that day
He hit him on the head with an oar]

On that day he let loose a single bolt.
Kagolo plunged into Kabyantabuzi rock.
I saw him sink down that day, his legs and backside . . .

When only his head was left above the rock,
When Mugasha came,
He said, "You, Kagolo,"
He said, "I–Nyatende–have come.
An only child, I ended my mother's childlessness."
He said, *"I–the Ashy-colored one–have come,*
One who jumps about."
And he said, "I–Kagolo–have come,
Of the Spirit Shrine,
Of the Water Oracle,
Missile of Despair,
Speaker of Angry, Dry Words,
With Stiffened Elbows.
Adorned with beads all over except the palm,
Of the Left-handers,
Of the Water Oracle."

I saw that day:
Kagolo had nothing to compare it to.
He said, "You, Kagolo! Get up, let's fight."
He refused.
He said, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."
The paddle hit Kagolo's head.
He said, "Come out, let's fight
I–the Trapper–have come."
He said, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."

Kayabugilemu emaili nka ibili
Yabona kil' ekyo
Yaikala ashobeilwe.
Yashalililwa.

Nkabona kil' ekyo
Okugulu *Njwenge* -

Yabilikila Nkuba *Kanyalumanzi* kil' ekyo
Ati, "Yanguha bwangu.
Nshange Kagolo aha mwalo.
Ataina kyakulenga."
[Kayaihyamu olulabyo lumoi kil' ekyo
Yamutela engahi omu mutwe]

Kil' ekyo yaihyamu olulabyo lumoi.
Yatobela omu lwazi Kabyantabuzi.
Nkabona yatobela amagulu n' enyio kil' ekyo.

Kayasigaize omutwe aha lwazi eigulu,
Kayaizile Mugasha,
Ati, "Iwe Kagolo,"
Ahi, "Naizile Nyatende,
Omwana omo nkamalila mawe obugumba."
Ahi, "Naizile *Lukujuju*,
Lutambuka na msheba."
Ahi, "Naizile Kagolo,
K' omu lwanga,
Ka Byantabuzi,
Owa Luhuba lwa kachubya,
Butoto bwa kyomya,
Nkokola zabaile igandami,
Buhunzile bwona busigaize akaganja,
Bwa nyin' emosho,
Ka Byantabuzi."

Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Kagolo akaba ataina kyakulenga.
Ati, "Iwe Kagolo! Imuka, tulwane."
Yayanga
Ati, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."
Yamutela engahi omu mutwe Kagolo.
Ati, "Lugamu, tulwane.
Naizile *Njwenge*."
Ahi, "Ti ti ti ti ti ti ti ti."

POETIC STANZAS

147: stanza in **abb formed by contrast between a quoted proverb (a : 147) and two lines of explication (b 's: 147.1, 147.2) each composed as proper noun subject + verb.**

145 I saw on that day:
Majambwe, Bull of the Heart-Tormenters,
Speaker from the Womb,
He comes from Mutoizi,
The Trapper.
His paddle hit Kagolo's head.
Kagolo flew out of Kabyantabuzi rock.

He told him, "Whoever hits your eye–you hit his nose."
Mugasha had one leg to stand on.
But to this day Kagolo never has found a word to say.
Nyatende Mugasha.

145 Nkabona kil' ekyo.
Majambwe Engundu ya bashahila mwoyo,
Kagambila-nda,
Aluga omwa mutoizi,
Njwenge.
Yamutela engahi omu mutwe Kagolo.
Yaluga omu lwazi Kabyantabuzi.

Akamugambila ati, "Akutela elisho -- Omutela enyindo."
Mugasha akemeleza okugulu kumo.
Na mambwenu Kagolo takabonaga kyakugamba.
Nyatende Mugasha.